

10-20°E
MERIDIAN

TOURISM'S SHADOW

THE PROMISE OF PARADISE

TOURISM IS OFTEN FRAMED AS ESCAPE, A MOVEMENT TOWARD BEAUTY, LEISURE, AND EASE. YET ACROSS COASTLINES AND CITIES, IT OPERATES AS A GLOBAL SYSTEM OF EXTRACTION AND EXCHANGE. IN EUROPE ALONE, IT DRIVES NEARLY 10% OF THE ECONOMY AND SUSTAINS MILLIONS OF JOBS, EVEN AS IT RESHAPES LOCAL ENVIRONMENTS, ECONOMIES, AND IDENTITIES. WHAT APPEARS AS PARADISE IS RARELY UNTOUCHED AND IT IS PRODUCED.

THE COST OF PARADISE

TOURISM PROMISES ESCAPE, BUT ITS IMPACTS RARELY REMAIN INVISIBLE. ALONG COASTLINES SHAPED BY GLOBAL DEMAND, RISING VISITOR NUMBERS STRAIN ECOSYSTEMS, ACCELERATE EROSION, AND GENERATE WASTE THAT LINGERS LONG AFTER THE SEASON ENDS. LOCAL ECONOMIES GROW, YET OFTEN BECOME DEPENDENT, RESHAPED TO SERVE VISITORS RATHER THAN RESIDENTS. WHAT APPEARS UNTOUCHED IS FREQUENTLY MAINTAINED AND CAREFULLY MANAGED TO PRESERVE THE ILLUSION OF PARADISE.

LINES OF CONNECTION

TOURISM DOES NOT OCCUR IN ISOLATION, IT FOLLOWS GLOBAL PATHWAYS OF MOVEMENT, WEALTH, AND DESIRE. ACROSS COASTLINES AND CITIES, THESE FLOWS CONNECT DISTANT PLACES THROUGH SHARED SYSTEMS OF TRAVEL, CONSUMPTION, AND EXCHANGE. WHAT HAPPENS IN ONE LOCATION IS SHAPED BY FORCES FAR BEYOND IT, REVEALING A WORLD LINKED NOT JUST BY GEOGRAPHY, BUT BY THE CONTINUOUS CIRCULATION OF PEOPLE, RESOURCES, AND INFLUENCE.

